

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

1Q26 Review: Macro risks in focus, but buffers and earnings resilience reaffirmed

DBSM.SI

12m Price Target: **S\$68.30**

Price: **S\$58.50**

Upside: **16.8%**

BUY

Melissa Kuang, CFA

+65-6889-2869 | melissa.kuang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Wayne Wang

+65-6889-2866 | wayne.q.wang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

DBS posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$2,930mn, +1%yoy/ +30%qoq, inline with GSe (see [1Q26 First Take - Inline with robust fee income offsetting slightly weaker NII, 2026 guidance largely unchanged](#)). At the analyst briefing, discussion centred largely on macro risks stemming from the Middle East and earnings resilience in a lower-rate environment. Management highlighted that extensive internal stress tests—incorporating sharp oil price shocks, FX volatility and broader macro dislocations—continue to point to adequate buffers, underpinned by conservative provisioning, a still-robust S\$2.4bn management overlay and limited direct exposure to the region, allowing DBS to maintain its SP guidance of 17–20bps. NII was another key focus amid lower SORA assumptions, with management reiterating comfort in holding to guidance for a slight decline, as weaker rates are expected to be offset by strong deposit growth and a slightly steeper yield curve. Wealth momentum was also discussed, with management noting a brief slowdown in early April amid market volatility but an improvement in activity later in the month, supported by resilient bancassurance contributions and expanding insurance cross-sell to SMEs. On capital returns, management reiterated its commitment to shareholder distributions but stopped short of guaranteeing the 6-cent DPS step-up for 4Q26 given macro uncertainty, indicating greater clarity could emerge in 2Q or 3Q, should conditions stabilise.

Overall, we see this as a decent set of results, with strong growth in wealth-related fee income—which management sees potential to exceed guidance—and robust liquidity growth reinforcing our thesis that DBS is well positioned to benefit from [Asia's structural liquidity inflows](#), supported by its strong franchise. Post results, we make minor changes to our 2026/27/28E net income estimates of +0.9%/+0.9%/+0.7% to S\$10,888mn/S\$11,844mn/S\$12,625mn. We maintain our Buy rating on DBS. Our 12-month target price is unchanged at S\$68.3 (based on a two-stage DDM). Key risks: (–) faster-than-expected rate cuts; (–) unexpected asset quality

Key Data

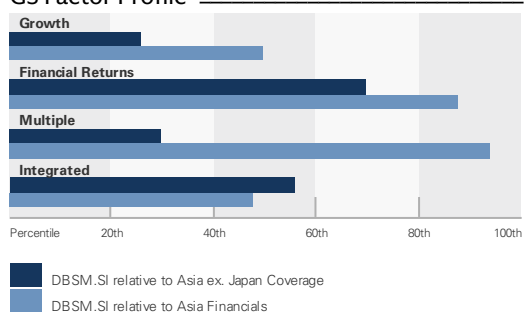
Market cap: S\$166.2bn / \$129.9bn
3m ADTV: S\$310.0mn / \$243.3mn
Singapore
Asia Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	11,033.0	10,987.9	11,944.5	12,724.8
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	11,033.0	10,889.9	11,835.0	12,643.0
EPS (S\$) New	3.88	3.89	4.26	4.54
EPS (S\$) Old	3.88	3.85	4.22	4.51
EPS growth (%)	(3.1)	0.1	9.6	6.5
P/E (X)	12.4	15.1	13.7	12.9
P/B (X)	2.0	2.4	2.3	2.2
Price/PPOP (X)	12.2	12.1	11.3	10.5
Dividend yield (%)	6.4	5.6	6.1	5.4

	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (S\$)	1.03	0.94	1.03	0.85

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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BUY

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Rating since Sep 1, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	12.4	15.1	13.7	12.9
Price/PPOP (X)	12.2	12.1	11.3	10.5
P/B (X)	2.0	2.4	2.3	2.2
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	6.4	5.6	6.1	5.4
Div. payout ratio (%)	78.8	84.9	83.1	69.9

Growth & Margins (%)

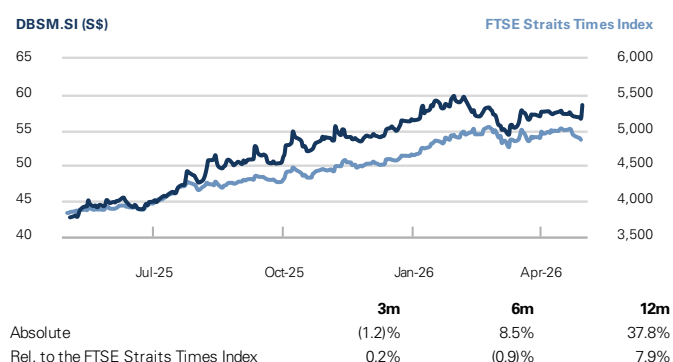
	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
BVPS growth	3.9	0.8	1.9	5.3
Total revenue growth	2.7	1.3	6.3	5.8
Op. profit growth	1.9	0.2	7.9	7.1
Net inc growth	(3.3)	(0.4)	8.7	6.5
EPS growth	(3.1)	0.1	9.6	6.5
DPS growth	37.8	7.8	7.3	(10.2)

Asset Quality

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.0	1.1	1.1	1.2
NPL ratio (%)	1.0	1.1	1.1	1.2
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.3	1.3	1.4	1.4
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	50.2	49.7	50.2	52.7
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	127.6	123.9	120.4	117.9

Capital Item

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	17.0	16.0	15.2	15.2

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 30 Apr 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net interest income	14,500.0	14,030.6	14,484.0	15,253.4
Net fees	4,898.0	5,577.5	6,440.1	7,037.0
Treasury income	3,361.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	141.0	3,600.0	3,744.0	3,818.9
Total revenue	22,900.0	23,208.1	24,668.1	26,109.3
Compensation & benefits exp.	(5,832.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(3,417.0)	(9,526.5)	(9,907.5)	(10,303.8)
Pre-provision op. profit	13,651.0	13,681.6	14,760.6	15,805.5
Provision for loans	(782.0)	(896.4)	(906.1)	(1,041.7)
Total provision expense	(791.0)	(896.4)	(906.1)	(1,041.7)
Income/(loss) from associates	262.0	269.9	283.4	297.5
Pre-tax profit	13,099.0	13,049.1	14,137.9	15,061.3
Provision for taxes	(2,066.0)	(2,059.3)	(2,191.4)	(2,334.5)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	11,033.0	10,987.9	11,944.5	12,724.8
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	11,033.0	10,987.9	11,944.5	12,724.8
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	3.88	3.89	4.26	4.55
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	3.88	3.89	4.26	4.54
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	2,840.7	2,827.4	2,803.9	2,803.9
Avg. yield on loans (%)	3.6	3.4	3.1	3.0
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	3.5	2.8	2.6	2.5
Cost of fund (%)	1.9	1.3	1.1	1.0
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.6	1.5	1.5

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Domestic mortgages	84,012.0	87,274.0	90,422.1	94,415.1
Domestic non-mortgages	44,437.0	46,162.4	47,827.6	49,939.6
Domestic commercial lending	283,376.0	294,378.8	304,997.6	318,466.1
Total overseas lending, gross	248,599.0	468,423.9	485,321.0	506,752.4
Gross loans to customers	450,916.0	468,423.9	485,321.0	506,752.4
Total NPLs, gross	4,629.0	5,042.9	5,467.5	5,962.3
Total loan loss reserve	5,905.0	6,249.8	6,583.6	7,030.0
Net customer loans & advances	445,011.0	462,174.1	478,737.4	499,722.4
Other interest earning assets	128,380.0	128,380.0	128,380.0	128,380.0
Interest earning assets	830,477.0	905,836.7	956,708.2	1,001,772.9
Other non-int. earning assets	67,011.0	67,407.8	67,820.6	68,250.2
Total assets	897,488.0	973,244.4	1,024,528.7	1,070,023.1
Risk weighted assets	365,381.0	388,423.6	412,995.5	435,664.2
CASA deposits	332,486.0	389,626.1	445,624.9	492,974.8
Non-CASA deposits	277,537.0	278,351.7	272,903.9	267,565.1
Customer deposits	610,023.0	667,977.8	718,528.8	760,539.9
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	59,703.0	59,703.0	59,703.0	59,703.0
Total liabilities	828,572.0	904,113.8	954,664.8	996,675.9
Total shareholders' equity	68,916.0	69,130.6	69,863.9	73,347.2
Total liabilities & equity	897,488.0	973,244.4	1,024,528.7	1,070,023.1
BVPS (\$\$)	24.24	24.43	24.90	26.21
RWA/assets (%)	40.7	39.9	40.3	40.7

Profit Drivers

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net customer loan growth (%)	3.3	3.9	3.6	4.4
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.6	1.5	1.5
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	40.4	41.0	40.2	39.5
Tax rate (%)	15.8	15.8	15.5	15.5
CASA ratio (%)	54.5	58.3	62.0	64.8
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	72.9	69.2	66.6	65.7

Profitability

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.7	2.5	2.5	2.5
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.0
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.6	1.5	1.5	1.5
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.5	1.4	1.4	1.4
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.2
Leverage (X)	13.0	14.1	14.7	14.6
ROE (%)	16.3	15.9	17.2	17.8
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	16.0	15.9	17.2	17.8

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

deterioration; (–) a slowdown in wealth growth.

More details from the briefing:

- **Asset quality remains manageable, supported by ample provisioning buffers.** DBS maintained its **2026 SP guidance at 17–20bps**, with GP reserves deemed sufficient to absorb potential risks. Management highlighted that internal stress tests incorporating oil price shocks (up to US\$150–200/bbl) and FX volatility across SGD, USD, RMB, INR and IDR indicate adequate provisioning headroom, supported by substantial GP reserves, including a S\$2.4bn management overlay. In addition, DBS has proactively de-risked unsecured consumer and SME exposures over the past year, particularly in India and Indonesia, where FX volatility is higher. Direct Middle East exposure is limited and skewed toward sovereign and high-grade credits. Overall, management expressed comfort with the portfolio. We remain conservative and forecast **2026E credit costs of 20bps**.
- **Record wealth fees but maintain guidance of mid-teens growth in 2026.** Wealth fees reached record levels in 1Q26, with bancassurance contributing ~20% of total wealth fees. AUM increased ~1% QoQ, supported by NNM of ~S\$10bn, comprising ~S\$6bn from high-net-worth/private banking clients and ~S\$4bn from DBS Treasures, with inflows broad-based across geographies with invested AUM accounting for ~58% of total AUM. Beyond the quarter, management noted that investment activity was muted in early April amid market volatility but improved later in the month with momentum continuing from previous quarter, while bancassurance remained resilient throughout. GTS momentum was also strong, with wins in cash management and operating account mandates. As such we see fee income to remain robust, **we forecast 14% fee income growth in 2026**.
- **Maintain 2026 NII guidance despite weaker SORA.** Management has updated its NII assumptions to 0 Fed cuts in 2026 and a lower SORA of 1.00% (from 1.25%), alongside high single-digit deposit growth (from mid single) and mid single-digit loan growth, while continuing to capture hedging opportunities. DBS also provided updated NIM sensitivities by currency: for the SGD book, a 1bp rate decline now reduces NII by ~S\$11mn (vs. S\$10mn previously), while the USD book sensitivity remains unchanged at a ~S\$4mn NII impact per 1bp rate decline. Beyond floating-rate exposure, DBS highlighted that ~S\$60bn of its S\$210bn fixed-rate asset base remains to mature in 2026 (S\$20bn has been repriced), with expected repricing now at ~40bps lower (vs. 50bps previously), implying a modest improvement to prior guidance. Management sees that despite weaker rates, it can still hold to its guidance of a slight decline in NII supported by more robust deposit inflow which will lend support to NII by deployment of the excess liquidity into high-quality investment securities, mainly government bonds, generating a ~1–1.2% spread. **We expect -3.2% YoY NII growth in 2026E, with NIM of 1.84%, incorporating a lower average SORA of 1.04% and strong deposit growth of 9.5%.**
- **Committed to S\$8bn capital return plan.** Supported by a robust capital position, with a fully-loaded CET1 ratio of 14.8% as of 1Q26, and sustained strong profitable. To date, 12% of the S\$3bn share buyback programme has been completed.

Management has kept the remainder of the programme open despite not executing buybacks since Aug last year, in order to preserve optionality should the share price decline sharply. Importantly, management reiterated that any unused portion of the buyback will still be returned to shareholders. Discussion also centred on the potential step-up in dividends in 4Q26. While management stopped short of guaranteeing this at this stage—citing ongoing macro volatility—they indicated that they would be more comfortable providing such guidance in 2Q or 3Q, should conditions stabilise.

Exhibit 1: DBS 1Q26 Results Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q26E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,681	3,648	3,578	3,593	3,494	(5)	(3)	3,546	(1)
Fee & Commission	1,275	1,167	1,357	1,099	1,482	16	35	1,403	6
Other Non-Interest Income	949	917	997	639	972	2	52	950	2
Non-Interest Income	2,224	2,084	2,354	1,738	2,454	10	41	2,353	4
Operating Income	5,905	5,732	5,932	5,331	5,948	1	12	5,899	1
Operating Expenses	(2,214)	(2,270)	(2,393)	(2,372)	(2,302)	4	(3)	(2,325)	(1)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,691	3,462	3,539	2,959	3,646	(1)	23	3,574	2
Loan Loss Provisions	(325)	(133)	(124)	(209)	(190)	(42)	(9)	(249)	(24)
Pre-tax Profit	3,437	3,388	3,482	2,792	3,512	2	26	3,393	4
Net Profit	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,258	2,930	1	30	2,866	2
Core Net Profit	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,358	2,930	1	24	2,866	2
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
Assets	840,823	841,896	881,622	897,488	935,365	11	4	911,327	3
Gross Loans	442,000	439,100	443,000	450,916	459,000	3.8	1.8	454,200	1
Non-Performing Loans	4,862	4,452	4,430	4,629	4,590	(6)	(1)	4,719	(3)
Customer Deposits	575,663	573,965	596,073	610,023	629,868	9	3	623,629	1
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	15.2	15.1	15.1	15.2	14.8			15.1	
NPL Ratio	1.10	1.01	1.00	1.03	1.00			1.04	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	30	12	11	19	17			22	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.12	2.05	1.96	1.93	1.89			1.87	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	37.5	39.6	40.3	44.5	38.7			39.4	
Loan-to-Deposits	76.8	76.5	74.3	73.9	72.9			72.8	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Contributing Authors: Melissa Kuang, CFA Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte, Wayne Wang Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte.

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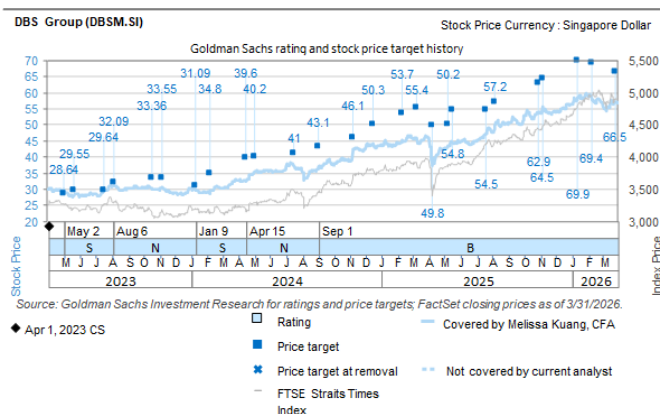
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Target price history table(s)

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Date of report Target price (\$\$) Closing price (\$\$)

15-Apr-26	68.30	57.70
26-Mar-26	66.50	57.12
09-Feb-26	69.40	58.19
13-Jan-26	69.90	58.47
06-Nov-25	64.50	55.54
29-Oct-25	62.90	53.70
07-Aug-25	57.20	49.75
21-Jul-25	54.50	47.26
18-May-25	54.80	44.60
08-May-25	50.20	43.09
09-Apr-25	49.80	37.16
09-Mar-25	55.40	45.98
10-Feb-25	53.70	45.38
16-Dec-24	50.30	44.31
07-Nov-24	46.10	41.70
01-Sep-24	43.10	36.36
16-Jul-24	41.00	37.36
02-May-24	40.20	35.55
15-Apr-24	39.60	32.40
07-Feb-24	34.80	29.50
09-Jan-24	34.20	29.88
06-Nov-23	36.90	30.68
18-Oct-23	36.70	30.32
06-Aug-23	35.30	31.14
18-Jul-23	32.60	29.57
22-May-23	32.50	28.10
02-May-23	31.50	29.95

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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